



Contemporary · venture investor, founder of 500 Startups.

"Measure the funnel, not the vanity."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

McClure wanted startups to stop chasing vanity metrics and focus on the few numbers that actually drive a business.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

From a background in software and early-stage investing, he distilled startup measurement into five actionable stages.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors Pirate Metrics (AARRR) — Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Referral, Revenue — in Unit 2's revenue-and-customer Slibrary.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

AARRR operationalises as measuring each stage of the customer funnel and concentrating experimentation on the weakest link.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

As a startup heuristic it can oversimplify complex businesses and underweight retention dynamics that later loop-based models emphasise.

ENDURING IMPACT

AARRR became a default framework in growth and product analytics, widely taught and applied across the startup world.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 2)

Erik Brynjolfsson · Giant 6

Robert Solow · Giant 7

Everett Rogers · Giant 8

Eliyahu Goldratt · Giant 9

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

McClure, D. (2007) 'Startup metrics for pirates', 500 Startups.

Croll, A. and Yoskovitz, B. (2013) Lean Analytics. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.